

CUSTOMER SUCCESS CASE STUDY

HOW A MULTI-UNIT FOOD AND CATERING BUSINESS INCREASED OUTSIDE SALES BY MORE THAN 100%

USING GRASSROOTS MARKETING, SOCIAL MEDIA, WEBSITE, EMAIL, EVENTS AND PROCESS IMPROVEMENT TO TURN LOCAL DEMAND INTO MEASURABLE SALES

Organisation	Multi-unit food and catering business
Period	January 2009 - June 2010
Role / scope	Internet Marketing Expert Local demand generation, sales growth and operating improvement
Audience	CMOs, marketing leaders, CEOs and hiring managers

EXECUTIVE OUTCOME

The work combined local marketing, social media, website, email and events with sales-process and operating improvements. The supplied material documents a 71% increase in outside sales within three months and growth of more than 100% within six months. It also documents a 75% improvement in order accuracy, adoption of a standardised questionnaire across 180 stores, a 2% improvement in P&L, a #2 chain-wide profitability ranking, 78% outside-sales growth in a later period, 4% higher store traffic and a 3% increase in average check size.

METRIC REGISTER AND PUBLICATION STATUS

Each metric is either documented in the supplied profile/project material or marked as an illustrative validation item. Validation items are prompts for recovering the original baseline, denominator, source and attribution; they are not public claims.

Metric	Value	Definition	Status / publication note
Outside sales	+71% in three months	Increase in outside sales during the first reported improvement window.	Documented outcome; confirm baseline and period.
Outside sales	More than +100% in six months	Increase in outside sales during the six-month reported window.	Documented outcome; confirm baseline and period.
Order accuracy	+75%	Improvement in order accuracy after process standardisation.	Documented outcome; define calculation.
Process rollout	180 stores	Number of stores adopting the standardised ordering questionnaire.	Documented outcome.
Average check size	+3%	Increase in average transaction value reported for the later period.	Documented outcome; confirm period.

BUSINESS CONTEXT AND CUSTOMER CHALLENGE

The business operated where marketing performance depended on digital reach, local awareness, reliable ordering, operational coordination and customer experience. Catering and outside sales required visibility in the surrounding business community.

The challenge was to improve sales during a difficult economic climate while reducing operational friction. A campaign could create inquiries, but inaccurate information or slow execution could weaken the result.

STRATEGIC DIAGNOSIS

The business had a local demand opportunity that was not fully activated. The surrounding community could become a stronger source of catering and outside orders through grassroots activity and digital channels.

Marketing and operations were connected. Incomplete ordering information created avoidable errors and rework, so process improvement became part of the growth plan.

CAMPAIGN SUCCESS MATRIX

The matrix makes the operating logic visible: business need, strategic move, execution system and success signal. It is deliberately designed for executive readers who want to understand how the work created a repeatable capability, not only a headline result.

Business need	Strategic move	Execution system	Success signal
Awareness	reach local business demand	Grassroots marketing, social and community activity	Higher outside-sales response
Conversion	turn interest into accurate orders	Website, email, events and clear offers	Outside sales +71% in three months
Accuracy	protect customer experience	Ordering questionnaire and process design	Order accuracy +75%
Profitability	improve commercial quality	P&L review, waste control and staff practices	2% P&L improvement and #2 ranking

APPROACH AND EXECUTION

1. 1. MAKE THE LOCAL MARKET VISIBLE

The first move was reach local business demand. The approach focused on the surrounding business community and framed catering as a relevant business solution. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex

marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. The approach focused on the surrounding business community and framed catering as a relevant business solution. The work was reviewed through the lens of awareness, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. Higher outside-sales response The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

2. 2. CONNECT TO THE SALES PROCESS

The first move was turn interest into accurate orders. The customer journey included the information required for reliable fulfilment, not only the initial response. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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3. 3. STANDARDISE THE HANDOFF

The first move was protect customer experience. A standardised questionnaire improved information quality and was adopted across 180 stores. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. A standardised questionnaire improved information quality and was adopted across 180 stores. The work was reviewed through the lens of accuracy, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. Order accuracy +75% The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

4. 4. LOOK BEYOND SALES VOLUME

The first move was improve commercial quality. The broader review connected sales growth with profitability, efficiency, staffing and training. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. The broader review connected sales growth with profitability, efficiency, staffing and training. The work was reviewed through the lens of profitability, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. 2% P&L improvement and #2 ranking The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

MEASUREMENT, ATTRIBUTION AND OPERATING DISCIPLINE

Outside-sales growth should state whether it refers to revenue, order count or another measure. Order accuracy needs a defined error or accuracy rate. The 180-store rollout is an adoption metric, while P&L and profitability ranking are broader outcomes.

A senior reader should be able to tell which evidence proves execution, which evidence proves engagement and which evidence proves commercial impact. The case therefore keeps metric definitions close to the story. Where the supplied material documents a practice-level or portfolio-level result, the narrative says so. Where a project-specific number is unavailable, the document names the recovery task instead of manufacturing precision.

BUSINESS IMPACT AND CUSTOMER-SUCCESS INTERPRETATION

The business gained a local growth engine and a better operating handoff. Outside sales grew rapidly, the questionnaire improved accuracy and became a repeatable practice across the chain.

For senior readers, this demonstrates adaptability. The marketer could identify a local opportunity, create demand, improve the process handling it and interpret the effect on the wider business.

WHAT THIS CASE DEMONSTRATES TO AN EXECUTIVE READER

- Local marketing is powerful when tied to a defined community and commercial outcome.
- Marketing and operations share responsibility for customer experience.
- Process standardisation can be a growth lever when it removes fulfilment friction.
- Sales growth should be evaluated alongside accuracy, margin and profitability.

End of case study